

“For Ubuntu fans and cheerleaders alike”

OMG! Ubuntu

www.omqubuntu.co.uk

Run by a fan, as the name would suggest, of the South African Linux maverick, this website is probably the best-designed and current Ubuntu fan-site there is. While OMG! usually takes up small issues like any fan-site (transparency enabled by default in 10.10 Meerkat, anyone?), its microscopic coverage of Ubuntu also means that occasionally it manages a spanking good read. In my opinion, OMG! carried the best follow-up article for those who installed Ubuntu 10.04. Consider its name: '10 Things To Do After Installing Ubuntu 10.04 Lucid', with links to install media codecs and apps. Written in simple language, the website usually includes one-click installation hyperlinks for new applications. It's easier installing apps from OMG! than from the distro's own software installer! Also check out OMG!'s application reviews—short, crisp little cookies.

Being a fan-site, *OMG!* is non-technical and non-critical. For instance, it won't exactly give you the scoop on why Lucid is sluggish on some computers, and can hog memory like a greedy relative. Anyway, that isn't *OMG!*'s brief; its



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brief is to rally the community around one of the best distros there is. Its name perfectly explains this: to keep carrying articles, day in, day out, which you can react to with a, "Oh My God! Ubuntu's So Cooooool!" OMG! makes a huge deal of such things as colour schemes, cool new wallpapers, GNOME themes, sounds and applications. It went to town over Lucid's aubergine fixation.

This website is easy to navigate, and more than easy on the eye. Also admire the better-than-professional quality layout and graphics of this website, and its unpretentious simplicity of language. It's definitely worth checking out once in a couple of days, if you are an obsessive Ubuntu fan.

"It's frank, open,
and free"

DistroWatch

www.distrowatch.com

We love distro-hopping; we love infidelity in that way. And so we read DistroWatch, which is the distribution review website, now in its tenth year. It announces distribution releases, distro upgrades and feature distribution reviews (seldom in-house, usually linked ones).

DistroWatch goes beyond being just a review site; it also carries a daily list of what it considers the 100 most popular Linux and BSD distributions. It measures this popularity by counting page views on the particular distribution's page on DW. Seems like a doubtful approach, right? Yet, DW is generally regarded as a reliable barometer of a distribution's popularity.

DW's format is user-friendly and informative. It mentions the features of releases, and also links to the download locations. In keeping with its neutrality, DW tucks hyperlinked distro reviews on its inside pages. All in all, DW is a good site to visit when you want to choose

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DistroWatch

which distro to hop to next. It makes you browse -- an enjoyable experience.

Being a listing website, DistroWatch is as neutral as Switzerland, even though its owners do sometimes air political views through the news magazine DistroWatch Weekly, published on the main site.

While DW carries sponsored articles, it labels them as such. If you've never visited DW, it's guaranteed infotainment and is very useful. New distros are added almost daily. To use a cliché, the website is one of a kind.